

CEO

Walter Ng, Spread Maximizer

CEO · EXECUTIVE

HIRE

◆ 5

SIGNATURE

Signature: one copy per deck.

Requires an Annuity funding source.

Commit this employee during a Stress Test to prevent up to 2 of your loss from its Longevity or Low Interest Rates clauses.

At the start of your turn, look at the top card of your deck. You may put it on the bottom.

Can quote the spread between the portfolio yield and the crediting rate to four decimals, at dinner.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 192 / 348

OFFICE LOCATION

Zurich

OFFICE LOCATION

OPEN

◆ 4 branch only

Headquarters or Open as a branch.

Commit this office during a Stress Test to prevent up to 3 of your loss from its Liquidity, Credit, or Low Interest Rates clauses.

The flag is a big plus!

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 327 / 348

FUNDING SOURCE

Traditional Variable Annuity

ANNUITY

CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 2 run start

▲ Long-Term Equity

▲ Low Interest Rates

▲ Volatility

▼ Inflation

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

Customers invest in the market; you guarantee they can't lose. What could go wrong?

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 007 / 348

FUNDING SOURCE

Traditional Variable Annuity

ANNUITY

CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 2 run start

▲ Long-Term Equity

▲ Low Interest Rates

▲ Volatility

▼ Inflation

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

Customers invest in the market; you guarantee they can't lose. What could go wrong?

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 007 / 348

FUNDING SOURCE

Traditional Variable Annuity

ANNUITY

CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 2 run start

▲ Long-Term Equity

▲ Low Interest Rates

▲ Volatility

▼ Inflation

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

Customers invest in the market; you guarantee they can't lose. What could go wrong?

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 007 / 348

FUNDING SOURCE

Index-Linked Annuity

ANNUITY

CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

CARRYING COST

● 1 each turn

▲ Short-Term Equity

▼ Long-Term Equity

Your maximum hand size is 1 higher.

Stock-market upside with a ceiling, downside with a floor, and an actuary in between.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 008 / 348

FUNDING SOURCE

Index-Linked Annuity

ANNUITY

CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

CARRYING COST

● 1 each turn

▲ Short-Term Equity

▼ Long-Term Equity

Your maximum hand size is 1 higher.

Stock-market upside with a ceiling, downside with a floor, and an actuary in between.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 008 / 348

FUNDING SOURCE

Pension Risk Transfer

ANNUITY

CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 1 run start

▲ Longevity

▲ Low Interest Rates

▼ Inflation

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

A company hands you its pension promises, keeping the logo while you keep the retirees.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 009 / 348

FUNDING SOURCE

Pension Risk Transfer

ANNUITY

CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 1 run start

▲ Longevity

▲ Low Interest Rates

▼ Inflation

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

A company hands you its pension promises, keeping the logo while you keep the retirees.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 009 / 348

Pension Risk Transfer

ANNUITY



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 1 run start

▲ Longevity ▲ Low Interest Rates ▼ Inflation

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

A company hands you its pension promises, keeping the logo while you keep the retirees.

A

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 009 / 348

Fixed Annuity

ANNUITY



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 1 run start

STAPLE

▲ Longevity ▲ Low Interest Rates ▼ Mortality

Staple: any number per deck.

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

Guaranteed checks for the customer; interest-rate nightmares for you.

A

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 010 / 348

Fixed Annuity

ANNUITY



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 1 run start

STAPLE

▲ Longevity ▲ Low Interest Rates ▼ Mortality

Staple: any number per deck.

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

Guaranteed checks for the customer; interest-rate nightmares for you.

A

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 010 / 348

Fixed Annuity

ANNUITY



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 1 run start

STAPLE

▲ Longevity ▲ Low Interest Rates ▼ Mortality

Staple: any number per deck.

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

Guaranteed checks for the customer; interest-rate nightmares for you.

A

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 010 / 348

Longevity Income Rider

ANNUITY



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 2 run start

▲ Longevity ▲ Low Interest Rates ▲ Regulation
▼ Mortality

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

A promise to keep paying, even when customers insist on living forever.

A

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 011 / 348

Longevity Income Rider

ANNUITY



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 2 run start

▲ Longevity ▲ Low Interest Rates ▲ Regulation
▼ Mortality

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

A promise to keep paying, even when customers insist on living forever.

A

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 011 / 348

Buffered Index Annuity

ANNUITY



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 2 run start

▲ Short-Term Equity ▲ Long-Term Equity ▲ Volatility
▼ Inflation

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

Customers get upside, you get basis risk, and everyone gets a brochure.

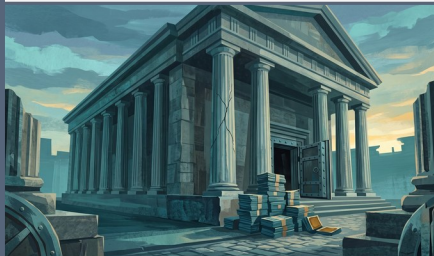
A

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 012 / 348

Long-Term Treasuries

INVESTMENT



COST

◆ 2

YIELD

● 1 each turn

SALE

1 any time

▲ Inflation ▼ Short-Term Equity

Destroyed if Debt Ceiling Breach hits you.

Typically boring, but caused the most recent bank run.

A

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 051 / 348

Mortgage-Backed Securities

INVESTMENT



COST

◆ 3

YIELD

● 2 each turn

SALE

2 any time

▲ Property Value ▼ Low Interest Rates

Destroyed if Great Recession or Housing Market Collapse hits you.

No longer the most volatile MBS.

A

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 056 / 348

Dynamic Hedging Program

TREATY



COST

◆ 3

SIGNATURE

Signature: one copy per deck.

Requires an Annuity or Financials funding source.

Carrying Cost: 1 Surplus per unhedged Short-Term Equity, Long-Term Equity, or Volatility exposure. Pay it at the start of your turn or discard this.

Halve your loss from Short-Term Equity, Long-Term Equity, and Volatility clauses (round down).

The hedge works perfectly, except when the market moves.

A
F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 112 / 348

Longevity Swap

TREATY



COST

◆ 2

Requires an Annuity funding source.

Carrying Cost: 1 Surplus per unhedged Longevity exposure. Pay it at the start of your turn or discard this.

Halve your loss from Longevity clauses (round down).

Your retirees can live as long as they like, now that someone else is paying for the extra years.

A

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 111 / 348

Protective Put

COVER



COST

◆ 2

COVER

Cover: discard it if that card leaves play.

Attach to one of your investments. Its exposures don't count.

A floor under one position, paid for up front.

A
F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 129 / 348

Reserve Release

RESPONSE

DARK



COST

◆ 1

DARK RESPONSE

Dark: Stress Tests can charge for it on your board or in your discard pile; Response: play while a Stress Test is being run.

Gain 3 Surplus.

This quarter's earnings agree that last year's reserves were too cautious.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 137 / 348

ALM Director

RISK & COMPLIANCE



HIRE

◆ 4

Requires an Annuity funding source.

Halve your loss from Low Interest Rates clauses (round down).

Matches every liability to an asset and every asset to a spreadsheet tab.

A

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 170 / 348

Hedge Desk Trader

RISK & COMPLIANCE



HIRE

◆ 3

Requires an Annuity or Financials funding source.

Commit this employee during a Stress Test to prevent up to 3 of your loss from its Short-Term Equity, Long-Term Equity, or Volatility clauses.

Rebalances the hedge at 3 a.m. so the guarantee still works at 9.

A
F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 171 / 348

Valuation Spreadsheet

SOFTWARE



PRICE

◆ 1

At the start of your turn, if you control an investment, gain 1 more Surplus.

Whenever a Stress Test with a Short-Term Equity or Long-Term Equity clause hits you, lose 2 more Surplus.

Tab 7 divides by the sum instead of the average, but nobody has opened Tab 7 since 2011.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 341 / 348

Chief Investment Officer

EXECUTIVE



HIRE

◆ 4

Requires an Annuity funding source.

At the start of your turn, if you control an investment, gain 1 more Surplus.

Believes every problem can be solved with another two basis points of yield.

A

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 173 / 348

1918 Influenza

MORTALITY · AS-IF REPLAY, 1918



COST

◆ 5

HITS

Each opponent

SIGNATURE ACT OF GOD

▲ Mortality ▲ Long-Term Equity

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped.

Each opponent loses 6 Surplus per Mortality exposure and 4 per Long-Term Equity exposure.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Cat Bond - Mortality it controls.

The 1918 influenza pandemic swept the world in three waves and killed tens of millions of people, many of them young adults.

A
F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 231 / 348

Record Heat Wave

MORTALITY



COST

◆ 2

HITS

Each opponent

FORECASTABLE ACT OF GOD

▲ Mortality ▲ Health Price

Forecastable: shown when drawn; can't be run that turn;
Act of God: can't be stopped.

Each opponent loses 4 Surplus per Mortality exposure and 4 per Health Price exposure.

The forecast called it a week in advance, and the emergency rooms filled anyway.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 224 / 348

Hurricane Andrew

NAT CAT - AS-IF REPLAY, 1992



COST

◆ 3

HITS

Target opponent

SIGNATURE FORECASTABLE ACT OF GOD

▲ Nat Cat: Flood ▲ Property Value

Signature: one copy per deck; Forecastable: shown when drawn; can't be run that turn; Act of God: can't be stopped.

Target opponent loses 8 Surplus per Nat Cat: Flood exposure and 4 per Property Value exposure.

In August 1992, Hurricane Andrew came ashore south of Miami with winds above 160 mph and destroyed or damaged more than 100,000 homes.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 227 / 348

Cook the Books

RESPONSE

DARK



COST

◆ 1

DARK RESPONSE

Dark: Stress Tests can charge for it on your board or in your discard pile; Response: play while a Stress Test is being run.

Prevent up to 4 loss to you from this Stress Test.

The numbers were fine once they had a little help getting there.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 136 / 348

Election Year Reversal

REGULATION



COST

◆ 2

HITS

Target opponent

ESCALATE

▲ Regulation ▲ Health Price

Escalate: pay 2 more to hit every opponent instead.

Target opponent loses 4 Surplus per Regulation exposure and 4 per Health Price exposure.

Every four years, half the actuaries update their assumptions and the other half update their resumes.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 240 / 348

Nuclear Verdict

LITIGATION



COST

◆ 3

HITS

Target opponent

▲ Litigation

Target opponent loses 6 Surplus per Litigation exposure and 1 per Dark card in their discard pile, plus 2 more.

The jury took forty minutes to reach a verdict that will take four years to appeal.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 261 / 348

Margin Call

LIQUIDITY



COST

◆ 3

HITS

Target opponent

BREAKING ESCALATE

▲ Liquidity ▲ Volatility

Breaking: can also be run at the end of another player's turn; Escalate: pay 2 more to hit every opponent instead.

Target opponent loses 4 Surplus per Liquidity exposure, 2 per Volatility exposure, and 2 per investment they control.

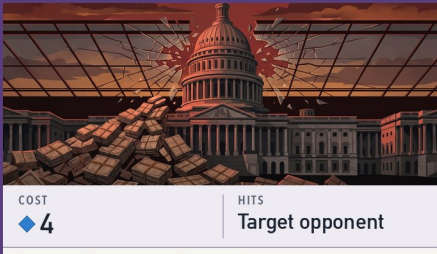
The broker would like a word, and also your cash.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 266 / 348

Debt Ceiling Breach

MARKET



COST

◆ 4

HITS

Target opponent

SIGNATURE FORECASTABLE ESCALATE

▲ Short-Term Equity ▲ Long-Term Equity ▲ Liquidity
▲ Short-Term Rates ▲ Volatility

Signature: one copy per deck; Forecastable: shown when drawn; can't be run that turn; Escalate: pay 2 more to hit every opponent instead.

Target opponent loses 4 Surplus per Short-Term Equity exposure, 4 per Long-Term Equity exposure, 4 per Liquidity exposure, 4 per Short-Term Rates exposure, and 2 per Volatility exposure.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Long-Term Treasuries it controls.

Everyone knew the date, which Congress treated as a suggestion.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 258 / 348

Accounting Standards Update

REGULATION



COST

◆ 2

HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE SYSTEMATIC

Signature: one copy per deck; Systematic: hits you too.

Every company loses 1 Surplus per Dark card on its board. Then each company discards its hand and draws that many cards.

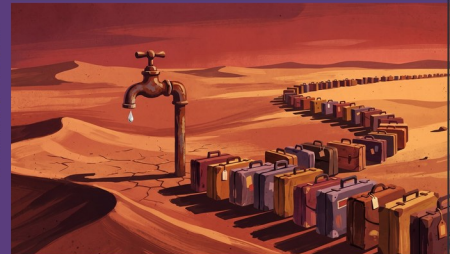
Effective for fiscal years beginning after the one you planned for.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 285 / 348

Liquidity Crunch

LIQUIDITY



COST

◆ 3

HITS

Target opponent

ESCALATE

▲ Liquidity ▲ Short-Term Equity ▲ Credit ▲ Volatility

Escalate: pay 2 more to hit every opponent instead.

Target opponent loses 4 Surplus per Liquidity exposure, 4 per Short-Term Equity exposure, 4 per Credit exposure, and 2 per Volatility exposure.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Private Credit Fund it controls.

Everyone wants cash, so nobody is bidding on your assets.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 260 / 348

Whistleblower

CORPORATE



COST

◆ 2

HITS

Target opponent

Target opponent loses 6 Surplus per Dark card in their discard pile.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Shell Company, Feeder Fund, Affiliate Loan, or Guaranteed Returns Fund it controls.

She kept copies of everything, including the email telling her not to.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 289 / 348

Funding Agreement Notes

ANNUITY · FINANCIALS



CAPACITY

◆ 1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 0

run start

SIGNATURE

▲ Short-Term Rates ▲ Liquidity

Signature: one copy per deck.

Sold like a bond, rated like a policy, spent like a lending fund.

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ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 043 / 348

Feeder Fund

ILLIQUID



COST

◆ 3

YIELD

● 2

each turn

SIGNATURE ILLIQUID

Signature: one copy per deck; Illiquid: can't be liquidated.

Destroyed if Whistleblower, Congressional Hearing, Bank Run, or Madoff Unmasked hits you.

Up about one percent a month for years, in every market, and nobody wanted to be rude and ask how.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 081 / 348

Des Moines

OFFICE LOCATION



OPEN

◆ 3

branch only

Headquarters or Open as a branch.

At the start of your turn, gain 1 Surplus for every 4 Life or Annuity funding sources you control, rounded down.

At the start of your turn, if you control a Life or Annuity funding source and a Private Credit Fund, gain 1 Surplus (once, regardless of copies).

Long lives, long loans, and a very short commute.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 330 / 348

LDI Overlay

TREATY



COST

◆ 0

SIGNATURE

Signature: one copy per deck.

While this is in play, 1 of your unhedged Low Interest Rates exposures counts as Liquidity instead. Each exposure can flip only once; earlier programs choose first. If none remain, this does nothing.

Matched for thirty years, with the cash due by four o'clock.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 155 / 348

Long Straddle

INVESTMENT



COST

◆ 3

SALE

1

any time

CARRYING COST

● 1

each turn

▼ Short-Term Equity

When a Stress Test with a Volatility clause hits you, gain 10% of the Surplus the whole table loses after protection and recoveries. Add your long-vol payouts, then round down.

Pays whichever way the market breaks, as long as it breaks before the premium runs out.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 096 / 348